

JAMES CHISULO

Founder / Software Engineer

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Portfolio: james-chisulo-portfolio.vercel.app/

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Self-taught Software Engineer and technology entrepreneur with hands-on experience designing, developing, deploying and supporting business software used by small businesses in Zambia. Founder of NTheemba Digital Services, a registered computer programming business focused on practical digital solutions for SMEs. Experienced in web application development, backend APIs, databases, system deployment, client onboarding, troubleshooting and user support. Built and deployed TradeFlow, a business management platform currently used by three real businesses, while also developing backend and integration systems using Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker and REST APIs. Previously worked in a structured contractor environment at Mopani Copper Mines, progressing through Cleaner, Cashier and Chef roles and developing responsibility in customer service, stock handling, food preparation and operational support.

KEY COMPETENCIES

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| • Software Development | • Web Application Development | • Backend Development |
| • REST API Development & Integration | • Database Design & Management | • Application Deployment & Configuration |
| • Technical Troubleshooting | • Client & User Support | • Software Implementation & Onboarding |
| • User Training | • System Documentation | • Business Process Digitisation |
| • Inventory & Business Management Systems | • Problem Solving | • Customer Service |

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Web: Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Google Apps Script, React, Tailwind CSS

Backend & APIs: FastAPI, REST APIs, API Integration

Databases & Data: PostgreSQL, SQL, Redis, IndexedDB, Google Sheets

Development & Deployment: Git, GitHub, Docker, Docker Compose, Vercel, Fly.io

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder / Software Engineer | NTheemba Digital Services · January 2026 - Present · Mufulira, Zambia

- Design, develop, deploy and support software solutions for small and medium-sized businesses.
- Built and deployed TradeFlow, a business management system currently used by three real businesses.
- Develop business applications covering inventory, sales, revenue, expenses, reporting and operational workflows.
- Configure software for client environments and support users during implementation, onboarding and training.
- Diagnose and resolve application errors, synchronisation problems, authentication issues and device compatibility problems.
- Design and integrate REST APIs; build backend services using Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL and Redis.
- Containerise development services using Docker and Docker Compose and implement offline-capable functionality using IndexedDB.
- Maintain technical documentation and work directly with business owners to translate operational requirements into software workflows.

United Benefits | Contractor to Mopani Copper Mines · 2019 - 2023 · Mufulira, Zambia

Chef · 2022 - 2023

- Prepared meals according to daily operational requirements and maintained food-safety, hygiene and cleanliness standards.
- Managed food ingredients and kitchen stock, monitored usage and supported timely replenishment of supplies.
- Worked within established contractor and mine-site procedures and supported smooth day-to-day kitchen operations.

Cashier · 2022

- Handled customer payments and routine cash transactions with accuracy.
- Assisted customers and maintained transaction records in a busy contractor environment.

Cleaner · 2019 - 2021

- Maintained cleanliness and hygiene standards within assigned work areas.
- Followed workplace safety and cleaning procedures and reliably completed assigned duties within Mopani Copper Mines site standards.

SELECTED SOFTWARE PROJECTS

TradeFlow - Business Management Platform

- Mobile-first business management system for SMEs and small retailers, currently used by three real businesses.
- Includes inventory and stock management, sales/POS workflows, revenue and expense tracking, dashboards and reports, restocking workflows, multi-shop support, authentication, offline storage and synchronisation.

Ntheemba - Business Messaging & Automation Platform

- Backend platform for business/customer conversational workflows and integrated business systems using Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Redis, REST APIs and Docker.
- Work includes session management, business-specific configuration and external service integrations.

NCPC - Central Product Catalogue

- Central catalogue and product-identification service supporting business systems such as TradeFlow.
- Work includes REST APIs, barcode/product identification, business-scoped integrations, authentication/token workflows and catalogue-to-business-system integration.

EDUCATION

Grade 12 Certificate | Petauke Boarding Secondary School · 2014 · Petauke, Zambia

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Digital Marketing for Entrepreneurs | Young African Leaders Initiative (YALI) Network · June 2025

Certificate of Completion

LANGUAGES

English - Fluent | Bemba - Fluent | Nyanja - Fluent

REFERENCES

Available on request.